



Course Name

NIGERIAN PEOPLE'S & CULTURE

Topic: Nigerian People's & Culture

WEEK 2

IN SUMMARY

In this week's lesson, you explored the diverse ethnic groups and their contemporary geographical divisions in Nigeria. Nigeria, with a history stretching back to 39,000 BC, is a melting pot of cultures that have developed over millennia.

The North West Zone is characterised by the predominance of the Hausa and Fulani people, who trace their heritage to conquest and assimilation, sharing a common language and Islamic faith. The North East Zone showcases the Kanuri and Jukun communities, known for their unique socio-political systems. Meanwhile, the North Central Zone stands out as the most ethnically diverse region, housing groups like Borgu, Nupe, Igala, and Tiv.

The Yoruba people take centre stage in the South West Zone, with distinct subgroups and a history deeply rooted in lineage and leadership. In the Southeast Zone, the Igbo community prevails, once thriving under a democratic age-grade system.

Lastly, the South-south zone exhibits ethnic diversity, featuring groups such as the Edo, Itsekiri, Ijaw, and Efik, all with democratic systems and influential kingdoms. These zones encapsulate Nigeria's rich history, cultures, and interactions, forming a diverse tapestry of traditions and beliefs, evident in shared origin stories, conflicts, trade, and religious practises.



BULLET POINT SUMMARY

- Nigeria is the most populous country in Africa, with a history dating back to 39,000 BC.
- Nigeria's six geo-political zones include North West, North East, North Central, South West, Southeast, and South-South, each with distinct ethnic groups.
- Notable ethnic groups in these zones include the Hausa and Fulani in the North West, Kanuri and Jukun in the North East, and various ethnicities in the North Central.
- The South West is primarily occupied by the Yoruba, the Southeast by the Igbo, and the South-South has diverse ethnicities, showcasing Nigeria's rich cultural diversity and history.



CASE STUDY

QUESTIONS TO PONDER

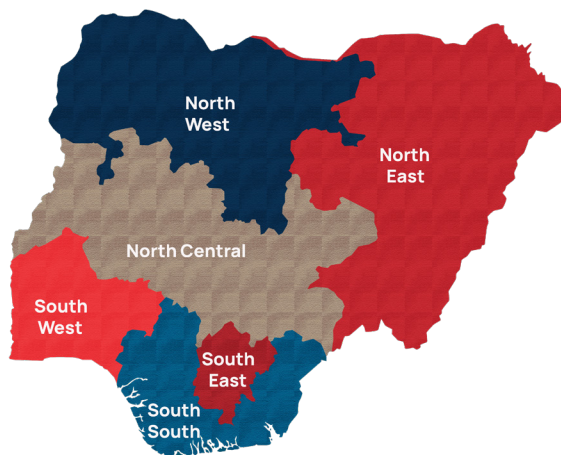
Title: Interactions and Influences: A Study of Nigeria's Geo-Political Zones

Introduction: This case study explores the intergroup relations and cultural influences among Nigeria's diverse ethnic groups within its geo-political zones. Nigeria, known for its rich history and diverse populations, offers a unique opportunity to examine the interactions between linguistic and cultural groups.

Objective: The objective of this study is to analyse indicators of intergroup relations, including traditions of origin, conflicts, trade, and religion, to better understand how different ethnicities in Nigeria have influenced and interacted with each other over time.

Methods: This study employs a comprehensive review of historical and anthropological sources to investigate the intergroup dynamics among ethnicities in Nigeria's geo-political zones. It examines key indicators such as traditions of origin, conflicts, trade relations, and religious practises to shed light on the complex tapestry of Nigeria's cultural interactions.

- Explain why the indicators of conflict, trade, and religion are crucial in uncovering the depth of intergroup relations in Nigeria.
- How have conflicts, trade networks, and religious practises contributed to cultural diffusion and connections among different Nigerian ethnicities?



SKILLS AND COMPETENCIES YOU HAVE ACQUIRED AFTER THIS LESSON

Geopolitical knowledge, Cross-Cultural understanding, and critical thinking.

PERSONAL REFLECTION

"How has the rich history of Nigeria, with its diverse ethnic groups, interactions, traditions of origin, conflicts, and shared cultural practises, contributed to the complex and multifaceted cultural identity of the nation today?"